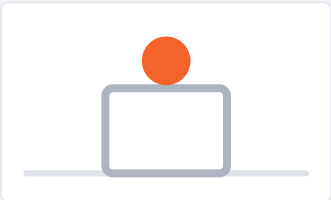
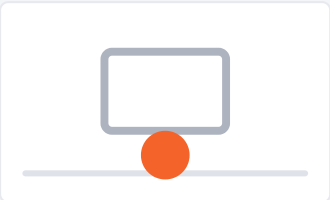
¿DÓNDE ESTÁ?
WHERE THINGS ARE

the grey box is the thing you are talking about — orange is what you are placing

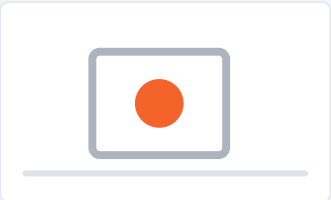
1. Sixteen positions read the picture first, then the word



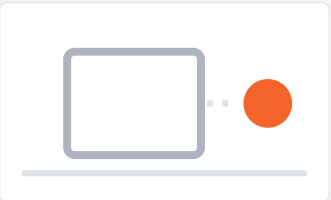
encima de
on top of



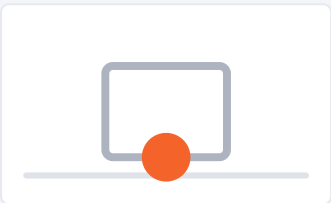
debajo de
under



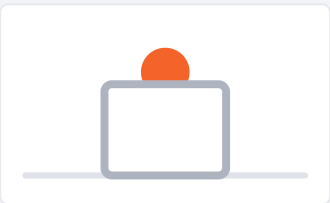
dentro de
inside



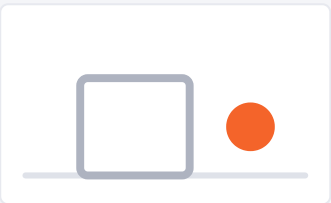
fuera de
outside



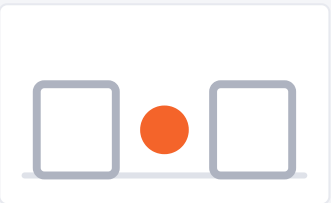
delante de
in front of



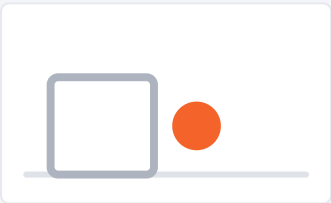
detrás de
behind



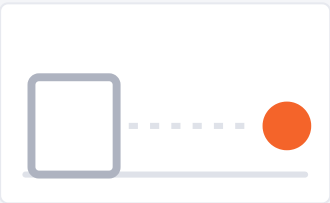
al lado de
next to



entre
between



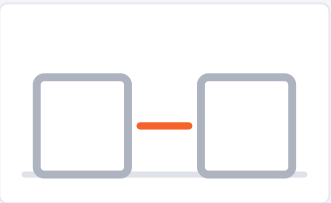
cerca de
near



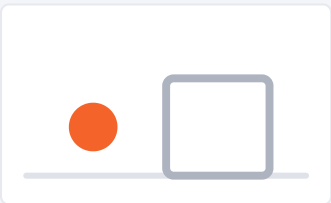
lejos de
far from



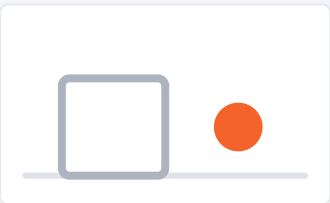
alrededor de
around



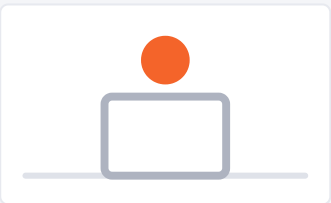
enfrente de
opposite



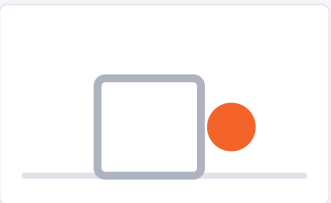
a la izquierda de
to the left of



a la derecha de
to the right of

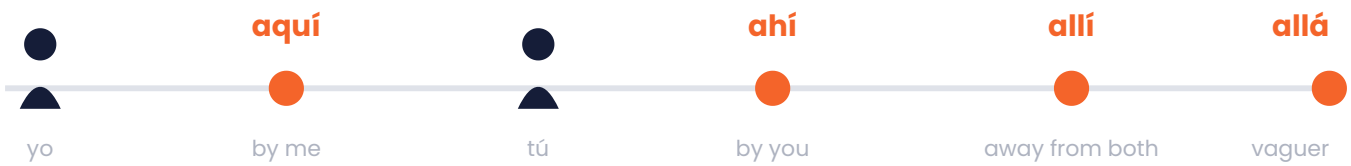


sobre
on, over



junto a
right beside

2. aquí · ahí · allí · allá English has two words for this; Spanish has four, and they measure distance from the speaker



They line up with **este · ese · aquel**: *este libro, aquí · ese libro, ahí · aquel libro, allí*. Learn them as pairs and you get both sets for the price of one.

3. They nearly all need de and the two that don't are the ones you will get wrong

encima **de** · debajo **de** · dentro **de** · fuera **de**
delante **de** · detrás **de** · al lado **de**
cerca **de** · lejos **de** · enfrente **de** · alrededor **de**
and *de + el* contracts: al lado **del** banco, lejos **del** centro

entre la mesa y la silla — no *de*, and it takes *y*
sobre la mesa — no *de* · same as *encima de*
junto **a** la ventana — this one takes *a*, not *de*
en la mesa — the everyday catch-all

The *de* only appears when something follows. *El banco está **cerca**.* — nothing after it, so no *de*. *El banco está **cerca de** mi casa.* — a noun follows, so the *de* comes back. Same for *dentro*, *delante*, *detrás*, *encima*.

All of these take **estar**, never *ser* — *el libro **está** encima de la mesa*. The one exception is an event: *la fiesta **es** en mi casa*. See **poster-ser-estar**, section 5.

Where things are
A1 — section 3 is the one to learn